Redmi Note 17 Pro Max

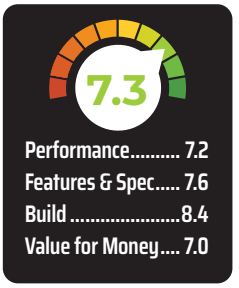
A battery-first phone with plenty to offer

After cameras, batteries seem to be the next big battleground in smartphones. Bigger battery cells are no longer limited to expensive phones, with mid-range devices now offering massive capacities, faster charging and the kind of backup that was once unheard of. Xiaomi is taking this trend to another level with its fan favourite Redmi Note series.

The Redmi Note 17 gets an 8,000mAh battery, the Note 17 Pro packs an 8,340mAh cell, while the Redmi Note 17 Pro Max goes all the way to a 10,000mAh battery. That is a number we are used to seeing on a power bank than a smartphone. They promise improved durability, a refreshed design, a bright display and good performance, which feels like a change.



But the conversation is also about the price. The Redmi Note 17 Pro Max costs Rs 13,000 more than the Redmi Note 15 Pro Plus. There are also some camera downgrades and changes in the performance section. So, does that massive battery and refreshed package justify the premium? After spending time with the phone and putting it through our tests, here's what the Redmi Note 17 Pro Max gets right and where it falls short.



BATTERY LIFE

This has to be the starter since we do not get to see a 10,000 mAh battery in many smartphones. On paper, the 10,000 mAh and 100W fast charging looks like a premium upgrade and our benchmarks also support this claim.

Our PCMark Work 3.1 battery test gave 27 hours and 41 minutes of screen-on time, probably the highest I have seen in my career. In real-world use, the 10,000mAh cell backs that up comfortably. After a full day of heavy use, streaming, social media, calls, browsing, and gaming, it still had plenty of battery left. If you ask me, you can get by for around 3 days on single charge.

In terms of charging, it supports 100W, and the adapter is included in the box. Despite the battery's size, a full charge from 0 to 100% took 1 hour and 36 minutes, which is fair. There's also 27W reverse wired charging, useful for topping up earbuds or you can also charge your other phone if you need to.

DESIGN

At 8.57mm, the Redmi Note 17 Pro Max is surprisingly slim for a phone packing a massive 10,000mAh battery. Despite the battery capacity, it doesn't feel anywhere near as bulky as you might expect from the numbers on paper. It is still a big phone. For my hands, one-handed use can be uncomfortable, especially when reaching for the top corners.

The back panel is made of plastic, and this is one of the few places where I expected a little more. Overall, the back panel looks interesting- the squarish camera module and the camera sensors do add value to the look and the colour also steals the show.

Coming to durability, the Redmi Note 17 Pro Max is among the strongest contenders in the segment. The display is protected by Corning Gorilla Glass Victus 2, and the phone comes with IP68 and even IP69K ratings for dust and water resistance. At the launch event, the company had dedicated demo zones where we saw the phone take bumps from a football, stay submerged in a glass of water for over half an hour, and go through more durability tests. You also get an optical in-display fingerprint, stereo speakers and an IR Blaster, making it a complete package.

DISPLAY

The Redmi Note 17 Pro Max features a 6.83-inch 1.5K AMOLED display running at 120Hz, and on the whole it's a vibrant display to use, colours look rich and scrolling feels smooth. Redmi claims 3,500 nits of peak brightness and somewhere the number justifies it. On our Lux meter at Digit Test Labs, the display measures 2,700 nits. In daily usage the panel is still bright enough that I never struggled to read the screen under direct sunlight during testing.

Colour accuracy is also reasonable. In our Calman Colour Test, the Redmi Note 17 Pro Max returned an average Delta E of 3.17, a reasonable if not exceptional result. In the Colour Gamut test, it measured 99.61%, which is also strong.

The display also supports Dolby Vision+ and HDR 10+ so the HDR content on Netflix and YouTube looks sharp, contrast remains strong and the viewing experience feels consistent.